

Cambridge Harkener

Celebrating the Heritage of Cambridge and Jeffersonville Vermont

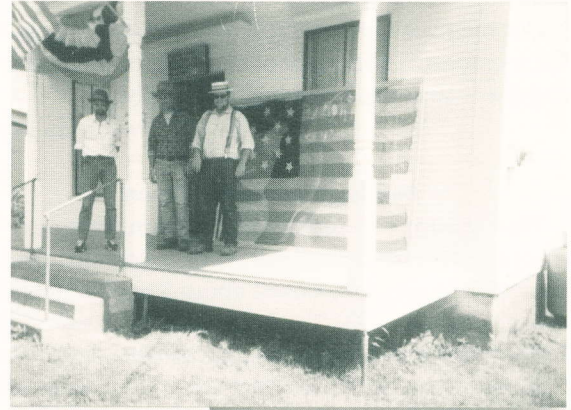
Cambridge, Vermont

Vol. I, No. 2

Fall 2001

Officers

<i>President:</i>	Adam Howard	644-2040
<i>Vice President:</i>	Roberta Marsh	644-2678
<i>Secretary:</i>	Marc Mallett	644-8882
<i>Co-Secretary:</i>	Julie Twombly Brown	644-1916
<i>Treasurer:</i>	Linda Ward	644-5189
<i>Directors:</i>	Diancy Boyden, Clark Dodge, Martha Kinney, Joel Page, Bill Putnam, Bill Sander, Jane Shaw	
<i>Honorary Directors:</i>	Harold Putnam, Wendell Wells	



The erstwhile barnraisers on the porch of the Warner Lodge Building after the parade

Cambridge Celebrates the 4th

On July 4th the Historical Society participated in Cambridge's annual Independence Day celebration. We were represented in the parade by a float depicting a barn raising, reflecting this years theme "People Helping People". The float was pulled by a tractor driven by Fred Boyden; Adam Howard, Bill Putnam and Rich Westman posed as the barnraisers. The women, represented by Holly Howard, Geana Little and Linda Ward, were shown preparing the food for the menfolk - very 19th century. Meanwhile, at the fair, the Society's Sugar on Snow booth was being staffed by Diancy Boyden, Amy Hutchins, Martha Kinney, Roberta Marsh and Julie Twombly-Brown. Clark Dodge, Jim Kinney and Ronnie Little kept the table supplied with the snow, which was stored at the Warner Lodge Building. The snow, collected last March by several hardy, if foolish, volunteers was a major success. The syrup, an equally important component of the dish, was generously donated by Dougie Edwards, Vermont Maple Outlet, the Fred Boydens, the Bill Putnams and the M. Page Marshs. A good and patriotic time was had by all who participated or attended. If you missed this opportunity to partake of sugar on snow out of season, you can still sate your appetite in September. See "Coming Events".



The women return to the 21st Century

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Treasurer's Report

As of this date our checkbook balance is \$8,192.16. This amount does not reflect the \$10,000.00 voted to us by the Town of Cambridge. At this time we do not have any outstanding bills that I am aware of.

Our membership is rising slowly and currently is at 124 members. Thirty eight of these are life members and the balance are individual and family.

—Linda Ward

Building Committee Report

We are happy to report that our fundraising campaign for 2001 has been very successful, and that to date we have raised about \$60,000 toward our goal of \$75,000. The balance is to be raised by CHS in the form of private and in-kind donations.

Most of you are aware that we are working with Michael Gohl, an architect from Hardwick, in drawing up plans for long-term adaptation of our building to the needs of our group. It is forcing us as a group to think about where we would like to be in five years. Towards that end, a questionnaire follows this report. Anyone with opinions on any or all of the questions should contact me (my address and e-mail are appended). We know you're an opinionated lot and we need your opinions now. Please share them.

We haven't been idle while waiting for Michael to complete plans. We have begun an exterior painting project that will help to preserve wooden siding while improving the appearance of our building. On August 4, a group of volunteers began repair of historic windows in the building.

This project is being done entirely with volunteer labor and will take several weeks to complete. We are scheduling workdays on the Saturday before each monthly meeting. The next session is September 8. There are jobs for people of every skill level. We'll need lots of help in order to have our windows ready for winter weather.

This project will improve building appearance and performance and will save us thousands of dollars. For those of you looking for a way to get involved on a project-by-project basis, this may be just the ticket!

What are your five-year goals for the Cambridge Historical Society with respect to:

- Membership. How many members will we have?
- Community. What will be our relationship to the community? What programs will we offer that require community involvement? What type of involvement?
- Collection. Will we operate a museum? Will we own the museum collection? Will the museum operate full time? Part-time?
- Building. What will our building be used for? Who will use it?
- What Cambridge Historical Society activity is your favorite? Your least favorite?
- What is the most valuable service offered by CHS?

Please forward your opinions to:

Douglas Porter
92 Church Street, Jeffersonville, VT 05464
e-mail—dwptil@together.net



Coming Events

* **September 12th** **Monthly Meeting**
A History of North Cambridge by Duane Chase

* **September 15th-16th** **Our Fall Fundraiser**
The Society will be serving Sugar on Snow, along with other comestibles at the annual "Celebration of the Vine Harvest" at the Boyden Winery

* **September 22nd** **Festival of Traditional Crafts**
The Fairbanks Museum in St. Johnsbury extends an invitation to all to come and enjoy this annual Festival from 9 am-5 pm

* **The Vermont Historical Society**
will be moving its Library and Offices to Barre over the winter. The Pavilion Building in Montpelier will continue to house the Museum, but all research facilities will be moved to the refurbished Spaulding Graded School in Barre and be open by June 2002.

Save Your Family History Part II *Preparing Textiles for Storage*

Before selecting storage materials, you should evaluate your collection, noting the types of fabrics, the size of the textiles, and their condition. It is also important to assess the storage space that you have available.

HANDLING

As you work with your collection, it is important that you handle textiles with care. Body oils can cause staining so wash and dry hands thoroughly and frequently. Do not use hand lotions and keep fingernails trimmed. Remove jewelry that could snag or rip a textile. Cotton gloves will keep textiles clean, but can abrade fragile surfaces.

Do not smoke, eat, drink, or use pens and markers near textiles.

Work on a clean, flat surface. Fragile items are best placed on a padded work table covered with cotton sheeting.

Support the textile at all times. Small, flat textiles can be moved on acid-free cardboard or placed in archival boxes. Never place any other object on the textile. Larger, rolled textiles should be moved on their tubes. The guiding principle is to minimize physical handling of the object.

Remove paper wrappings that are acidic and attachments such as pins and staples. If the wrapping contains information, retain and store separately or copy the details into the accession record. If you find signs of mold or insect infestation, isolate the textile in a sealed polyethylene bag and contact a conservator for advice on treatment.

CLEANING

Modern garments such as wedding gowns or christening gowns are among the most common items to be saved. They should be cleaned immediately after wearing because soil and stains become more difficult to remove as they age. Most wedding gowns will require dry cleaning. Request fresh or filtered solvent. Identify all the stains before treatment. Christening gowns and other textiles of cotton, linen, or synthetic blends may be washed. Follow directions on the care label. When in doubt, it is safest to dry clean.

Cleaning is more problematic for older, historic textiles. Washing and dry cleaning subject a textile to stress and should be done under the direction of a conservator.

All but the most fragile textiles can be safely vacuumed. Lay the textile on a covered support

sheet, and cover with a clean fiberglass window screen. Using a hand-held, low-power vacuum, pass the nozzle gently over the covered textile. Never vacuum the textile directly.

REPAIR

If you have a new textile, a skilled seamstress may be able to make the required repairs. Older or historic textiles, however, should be reviewed by a conservator who has the experience and expertise to evaluate condition and recommend appropriate treatment. The American Institution for Conservation (202-452-9545) offers a free referral service and will give you the names of textile conservators in your region.

LABELING

Identification information should be placed on the storage container so textiles are not unwrapped and handled needlessly. Boxes, tubes, or other supports can be labeled in pencil. Avoid the use of pens or markers around any textile.

Sew-on tapes made of cotton twill can generally be used safely, consult a textile conservator when establishing labeling procedures for a valuable textile.

—Excerpted from Gaylord Co. Archival Products

Vermont History Expo — June 23-24, 2001

In its second year, the Expo was better yet! Set in the beautiful Tunbridge Valley Fairgrounds, the Expo featured almost one hundred societies displaying projects, treasures and talents. Buildings and huge tents sheltered lectures, music, costumed historical figures and imaginative booths. Everything represented Vermont's rich past. When a Civil War Encampment fired guns down the hill, we were transported back in time! Add in food and dances - great event! This is a "must" for our society next year. Samples from some local towns:

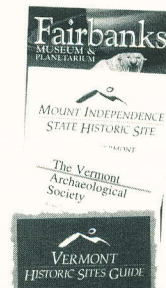
Bakersfield - History of its three academies

Enosburgh - Displays of its five century farms

Fairfield - A talking outhouse! It narrated old tales of local natives.

East Montpelier - Displayed the beauty of its barns.

Just some of the organizations with exhibits at the Expo



—Carol Bacon

The Cambridge Project

The following article was written by two sixth graders - Justin Marsh, son of Jerry and Shawna Marsh and Hunter Gomez, son of Doug and Dodi Gomez - for their class project "A History of Cambridge".

They spent two hours interviewing me, and then returned to their classroom and wrote the article, which was published in the school newspaper and was also chosen for Vol. 12, 2001 "Fine Print". I was certainly impressed as I believe you will be also.

—Roberta Marsh

History of Cambridge Justin Marsh and Hunter Gomez

"Wow, neat, cool, awesome!" That was what we said while we interviewed Roberta Marsh. Mrs. Marsh is the vice-president of The Cambridge



The authors with their source
in front of the former Cambridge Inn

Historical Society. Man, did she tell us a lot of useful and interesting info for our History of Cambridge unit. So now let us share some of our new knowledge with you.

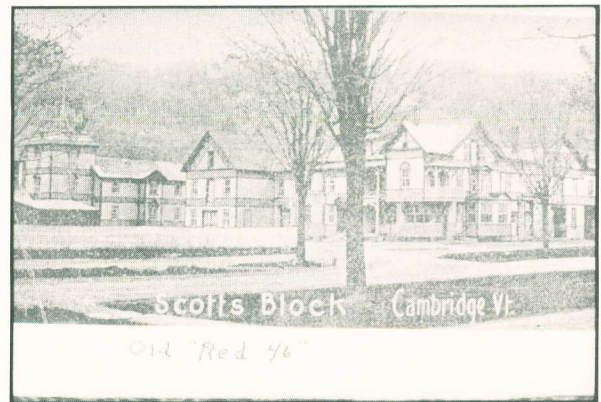
Cambridge was chartered in 1781, which was ten years before Vermont was admitted into the union (1791). The first settler came in 1783; his name was John Spafford.

They decided that they had to split the land up into lots so people would settle here. They decided to make three conditions in order to own land (you must have had at least 1 of these). 1. You had to plant five acres of crops and raise it. 2. You had to build a house that was 18 ft. squared. 3. You had to have your family settled there within three years. The reason they did the third one was so the men could build the house, and then bring the wife and children to Cambridge. Dividing the land like this was called "privileges". People were very selfish with this.

There were only 65 people here the first winter after the first settler came. Then, in 1791, there were 359 people here!

There was one settler who came to Cambridge named John Warner. He came with 35 cents in his pocket. He started out working as a helping-hand for a Courier Shop. Then he raised some mules for the Union Army in the Civil War. He then saved up his money and started up a Tannery Shop. Later he became one of the richest persons in Vermont.

The first post office was in Cambridge Village in 1804. Jeffersonville had no P.O. until 1831. There were 6 Post Offices in Cambridge at one point! Did you know that what is now Cambridge Village was called Cambridge Boro? And Jeffersonville was called Cambridge Center. There was a mix-up with mail because people wouldn't tell exactly where they lived. Did you also know that Jeffersonville was named after the former president, Thomas Jefferson?!



Have you ever gone to the Red 46? Chances are you haven't! This was a building in Cambridge Village that nobody knew why it was called that. The people didn't really care. All they wanted was the apartments, restaurants, a funeral parlor, stores, and even a box maker! This building was located along the railroad where the Mobil station in Cambridge is. Sadly the building mysteriously burned in 1931.

At the end of the Red 46 was the Grand Army Hall. It also sadly burnt in 1910. It's neat to know that the soldiers would run drills on Rte. 15 in Cambridge Village. Did you know that is why Rte. 15 was given the honorable name of "Grand Army of the Republic Highway"?

Cambridge provided 309 men to go into the Civil War!

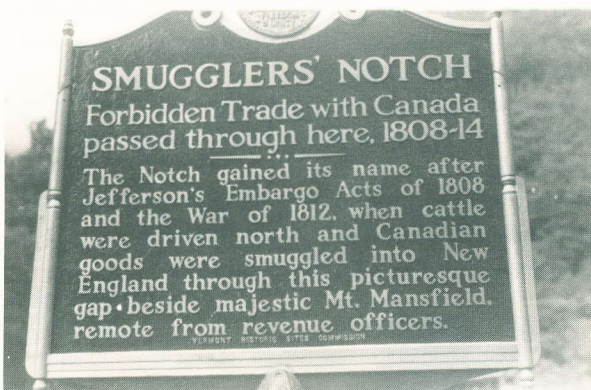
Have you ever been to the Cambridge Inn? Well that was a log cabin in 1826. It was in Cambridge Village. It was a popular hotel. So when the soldiers would come with their families, they'd stay and dine at the Cambridge Inn.

Peleg Stearns built this beautiful building (Cambridge Inn). Stearns didn't want any competition, so he asked the owner of the other hotel to keep his doors closed. He would pay him only \$75 a year. The other owner agreed with this deal! One of the owners of the Cambridge Inn raised pigs. He'd let his pigs roam around on the front lawn. Have you ever been on Mansfield Dr. in Cambridge Village? Well it was first called Pig Lane because of all the pigs!

Attached to the inn was a shed for parking horses. There was also a big dancing hall. People had more of a social life than we regularly have today.

So, the Red 46, The Grand Army Hall, Cambridge Inn, and the Dancing Hall were the big things Cambridge was noted for. People from Burlington and Essex would come on the train to enjoy what we had.

Have you ever been up to Smugglers' Notch? Did you know how it got its name? It happened when smugglers (people who would bring gold or alcohol from Canada) came. They'd hide in the mountains around the notch where they could get over to the other side.



The first school was on Pumpkin Harbor Road. It was a small log cabin. There were many schools in Cambridge. As some of you know, Lamoille

County is divided into two districts now. Cambridge was divided into about 20 districts (so there were 20 schools!)

Bert Reynolds was a sportsman in town. He started a baseball team. They were a very good team.

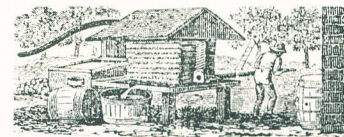
Have you ever been on the road to Smugglers' Notch? That is now called Mill Street. There used to be a line of companies along Mill Street including a tub shop. The businesses were powered by hydroelectric power (power from water). The old name for the road was Water Street.

Where Pocket Full o' Posies is now, there used to be a general store named Noble and Pearl.

They moved one of the stores in Cambridge Center with a Ford truck.

So that was just a tad of information we got from Mrs. Marsh. We hope to share more with you soon.

Thank you, Mrs. Marsh!



Newspaper Stories from the Past

1868

"Good dry hard 20" stove wood for \$2.00 per cord"

[Today's price would be \$150.00]

1892

"Last week C. L. Demerit of East Cambridge drew to the mill 1550 feet of ash logs selling at \$15.00 per thousand - they are to be worked into oars."

[Today they sell on average for \$300.00 per thousand, and they were as much as \$800.00 a few years ago]

"There is talk of laying out a new street back of the school house in Jeffersonville through Mr. Varnum's meadow."

[Of course, we know they did]

1893

"Raspberries are plentiful this season in Cambridge Junction. Mrs. Chayer and two boys have picked 400 quarts."

1888

Luther Putnam [Harold's grandfather] has sold more than 1600 quarts of garden strawberries this season."

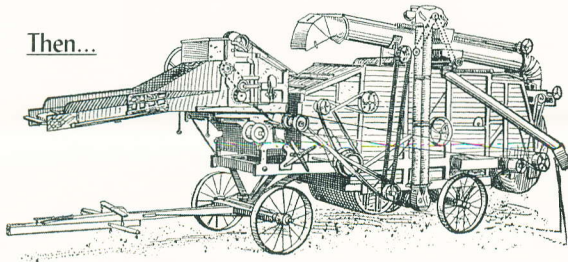
Grain Harvesting Then....and Now

The Good Old Days???

Gone are the days when my Dad, Martin Dodge, would cut buckwheat with a grain cradle then thresh the heads of grain off on the barn floor using a bean or grain flail. The chaff was separated from the grain by sifting and winnowing it with the wind blowing through it. It was then ground in a small grinder attached to the pantry shelf. The end result was now flour for buckwheat pancakes; which I recall being very heavy and hard to digest.

When my Dad would grow beans for baking, the beans were stacked on a small pole with short branches left on to hold the bundles of beans while they dried. When dry they were placed on the barn floor where he would pound off the beans with the flail. We had a fanning mill that blew wind through and cleaned the beans. They were then dumped from one vessel to another to let the wind do a final cleaning.

Then...



We had a Samsonville threshing machine that was made in a small factory in the town of Samsonville which was between Enosburg Falls and Berkshire, Vermont. Then came the Deering Reaper which cut the grain, oat, wheat and barley, tied them into bundles which were stacked in the fields to dry.

Next came a man named Monte from Berkshire with his large Canadian type thresher. Out with the old wooden contraption now beyond repair! This bigger machine would thresh, bag grain and blow the straw into a stack. I remember standing in back of the machine and pushing the straw into a baler for tying it into bales for storage.

Now along comes the combine which cut and threshed the grain in one operation leaving the straw on the ground to be picked up later.

About 1952 or 1953 I purchased a small combine. It was a John Deere five foot model, drawn by a tractor, with a power unit that operated the machine. A man was required to ride on the machine and tie up the filled bags and slide them down a chute to the ground to be picked up later.

One time one of the empty bags caught fire on

the machine's manifold. I stopped the tractor and yelled to Allen Irish, who was setting on a bench above the gasoline tank, to get off quick! We put out the fire, collected our wits and went back to doing our job.

With the new concept of threshing I was kept busy. All the farmers wanted to be first. I had a hard time to convince them when their grain was ready. It was different now from when they would reap and thresh later. Back then they stored the grain when it was dry and threshed on the barn floor during a slack time from other chores.

My little Ford tractor and combine traveled over a lot of territory from Fairfax, Westford, Johnson, Cambridge and even a trip to Lake Elmore.

Now there is the self-propelled combine like the one Fred Boyden has.

I have lived through a huge change from the days of my father's grain cradle, flail and forks to the huge monster machines of today.

—Clark F. Dodge Sr.

Now there is the self-propelled combine like the one Fred Boyden has.

Modern day grain harvesting is accomplished with a self-propelled machine called a combine. Its name is derived from the fact that it combines two functions - reaping and threshing. In operation, the machine cuts the grain in 12-30 foot swathes. The grain heads are threshed and then travel up a conveyor to a storage area, which holds 100-300 bushels. The straw travels up the straw walker shaking off any excess grain as it goes. The straw then falls out the rear of the machine. When the grain bin is full, the machine's auger swings out over the waiting grain truck and unloads within 3-5 minutes.

The combine is a complicated machine full of many working parts. Many hours can be spent maintaining it.

The combine is used for all grain, corn and soybeans. After the grain is harvested, a different head, called a corn head, is attached to harvest the corn.

—Fred Boyden

...Now



Harold Putnam Celebrates 87 Years

CLOVERDALE—Few members have been more influential to the resurgence of the Cambridge Historical Society over the past several years than Harold Putnam.

Soon to celebrate his 87th birthday, Harold has worked tirelessly to record and pass down countless memories of his beloved Cloverdale farm, Cambridge and Jeffersonville. As a representative of one



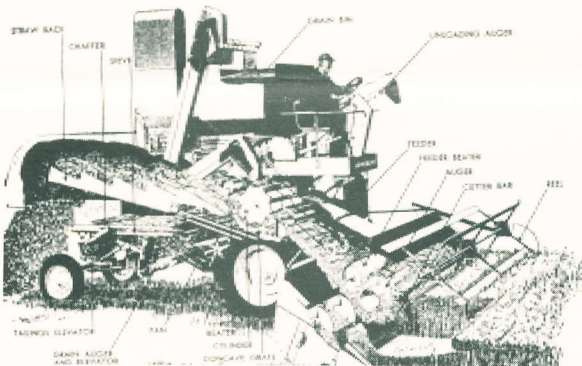
of the oldest families in town, Harold is not simply a conveyor of tales and local lore, but a true historian, exacting a legacy that balances the traditional oral histories common in our rural landscape with extensive research and commitment.

"His roots go really deep," daughter Beth Cole says. "He has a lot of pride in that. The older he gets the more cognizant he is of that. He's real concerned about passing that down."

Passing it down is exactly what he's been doing. With the aid of his granddaughter Debbie Cole, Harold delivered an impressive history of the Cloverdale area at June's CHS meeting. (Rumor has it that there's a second presentation coming up in the fall.)

Happy Birthday Harold, and Thank you for all your hard work!

—Adam Howard



A Note about Collections and Donations

At the present time we have no safe area for storage. We would, however, like to know what people in the community would be willing to donate to the Society so that we can begin addressing our needs for the future. We must decide where and if we can exhibit or store items. We must consider space, time, and dollars.

We are asking for photos, artifacts, videos, oral histories, books, etc. Anything you would consider relevant to the history of our town.

The Collections Committee will follow guidelines set up by the Vermont Historical Society that have been found to be practical for use. If you have any questions you can contact Carol Bacon (644-5065). Any Board Member could also be of assistance.

Volunteer Opportunities

Many of you cannot make it to the monthly meetings, but would like to contribute in some way. Volunteers are needed to man the tables at the Vine Harvest Festival as well as to contribute delicacies to sell. Many of you will be contacted soon and requested to donate time or tarts. Don't wait! If you would like to contribute to CHS by helping out please call Diancy Boyden at 644-2212.

Also, don't forget the monthly Window Workshops on the Saturday before our meeting. Call Doug Porter at 644-5939 to find out the exact schedule.

The Historical Society is always looking for new subjects to spotlight, both in this newsletter and at the monthly meetings. Recent meetings have been well attended, thanks to the speakers, who have been highlighting the history of the various sections of Cambridge. If you have a subject you would like to discuss, or hear about, please contact Carol Bacon of the Program Committee at 644-5065.

Think about it!

Meetings are held the 2nd Wednesday of the month at 7:00 pm
Warner Lodge Building, School Street, Jeffersonville.
We hope to see you at the next meeting.



Brown, David & Julie
1906 VT RTE 108N
Jeffersonville, Vermont 05464



Cambridge Historical Society
Warner Lodge Building
School Street
Jeffersonville, VT 05464